

Only Coding

DSA & Java Practice Roadmap (Organized from Personal Notes)

Objective

The goal is to organize all coding problems topic-wise to enable structured preparation for Data Structures & Algorithms (DSA).

Initial focus was on Java Collection Framework (JCF) to build a strong base for solving these problems.

1. Pattern / Loop-Based Problems (Beginner Level)

Purpose: Build logic using loops

- Pyramid Pattern
- Diamond Pattern
- Left Triangle Pattern
- Right Triangle Pattern

2. String Problems

◆ Basic

- Reverse string (with / without built-in methods)
- Palindrome check
- Prove string immutability

◆ Frequency-Based (Using HashMap)

- Duplicate characters in string (e.g., "Mississippi")
- Distinct character count
- Most frequent character

◆ Advanced

- Anagram check
- Longest substring

- Count palindromic substrings

3. Array / List Problems (Core DSA)

◆ Basic

- Find max / min element
- Second largest element
- Reverse array
- Rotate array by k

◆ Intermediate

- Merge two arrays (without duplicates)
- Split array into chunks
- Find missing number
- Find common elements

◆ Advanced

- Triplet sum problem
- Longest consecutive sequence
- Sliding window maximum

4. HashMap / HashSet Problems

◆ Frequency Problems

- Count occurrences of elements
- Distinct element count
- Most frequent element

◆ Set-Based Problems

- Remove duplicates
- Union of arrays
- Intersection of arrays
- First repeated element

◆ **Advanced**

- Top K frequent elements
- Graph adjacency list using HashMap

● **5. Java 8 / Stream API**

◆ **Basic**

- Convert collection to stream
- Sorting
- Filtering

◆ **Intermediate**

- Sum and average
- Find longest string
- Distinct elements

◆ **Advanced**

- Group employees by department
- Nested grouping
- FlatMap problems

● **6. Stack / Queue**

- Parenthesis balancing
- Stack implementation using arrays
- BFS / DFS basics

● **7. Linked List**

- Reverse linked list
- Detect loop in linked list

8. Trees

- Tree traversal (Inorder, Preorder, Postorder)

9. Graph

- Adjacency list (using HashMap)
- BFS and DFS traversal

10. Heap / Advanced Problems

- Sliding window maximum
- Kth largest element

Key Insight

The difficulty in solving problems is not due to weak concepts, but due to lack of structured progression.

Study Plan (Recommended Approach)

Phase 1: Foundation (Current Stage)

- ArrayList
- HashSet
- HashMap

Focus on:

- Frequency problems
- Duplicate handling
- Union / Intersection
- Missing number
- Longest consecutive sequence

Phase 2: Core DSA (Array + String)

- Two Sum
- Anagram
- Sliding window basics
- Subarray problems

Phase 3: Intermediate Data Structures

- Stack
- Queue

Phase 4: Advanced Structures

- Linked List
- Trees